

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Upper Elementary | Unit 4

Change y to i


Today I am learning when to **change final y to i** before adding a suffix.

1 Learn the Rule

When a base word ends in a **consonant + y**, change the **y to i** before adding many suffixes. Keep the y before **-ing**.

happy + ness = happiness carry + ed = carried
easy + er = easier carry + ing = carrying

2 Build the Word

Change final y to i when needed, then add the suffix.

Base word	Add suffix	New word	What changed?
try	-ed	_____	_____
worry	-ed	_____	_____
happy	-er	_____	_____
lazy	-est	_____	_____
carry	-ing	_____	_____

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

On Friday, Lily **carried** a box of art supplies to the community room. She had **hurried** because she **worried** the others would start without her. First, she **tried** to hang a paper banner, but it slipped. Maya **replied** that they could tape it more securely. Soon, the room looked **prettier** and everyone felt **happier**. Lily **easily** sorted the markers by colour and **copied** the activity signs. Later, she **carried** trays to the table and **tried** a new painting idea. When the younger children arrived, they were **happiest** at the craft table. Lily smiled because the afternoon had been **busier** than she expected, but everything was ready on time.


Find and highlight words where the final **y** changed to **i**.

4 Word Detective

Choose one **y-to-i** word from the passage and investigate how it was built.

- Write one y-to-i word from the passage.

- What is its base word?

- Which suffix was added?

- Show the word sum: base + suffix -> new word.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words into the correct group.

carried worried happier played enjoyed carrying

Final y changed to i

Final y stayed as y

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- I felt _____ when _____.

- Use another **y-to-i** word in a sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Spots when final y changes to i
- ☐ Builds y-to-i words accurately
- ☐ Reads changed words accurately
- ☐ Explains when y stays as y



Capture idea:

Find a word ending in **-ied**, **-ier** or **-iest**.
Work back to the base: did y change to i?